écentic — Go-to-Market Strategy

Last updated: 2026-06-02 **Horizon:** 12 months from round close

Strategy summary

Win the Shopify ecosystem first. Win it through the App Store, content-led inbound, and a small set of enterprise pilots delivered through the Plug and Play network. Don't try to sell into every commerce stack at once — that's how early-stage SaaS dies.

The motion is product-led at the bottom (Connect tier, self-serve via App Store) and sales-led at the top (enterprise pilots scoped manually). Compete tier sits in the middle and converts from Connect via in-product upsell prompts.

Three motion channels

1. Shopify App Store organic + content SEO (Tier A, Tier B)

This is the volume play. Shopify's App Store generates millions of merchant searches per month. A well-positioned listing in the "agent optimization" category (which is forming in 2026) gets installs without paid acquisition.

Tactics: - Shopify App Store listing live by end Q3 2026 with first 25 paying merchants - "Built for Shopify" badge pursued in Q4 2026 (requires demonstrated install volume + retention) - Content engine: YouTube tutorials, blog posts on agent commerce, comparative pieces vs. GEO tools - Free public UCP validator at ecentic.ai/validator drives top-of-funnel - Quarterly "State of Agent Commerce" report — first edition Q4 2026

Year 1 install target: 600 Shopify App Store installs (free + paid) **Year 1 paid conversion target:** ~20% = 120 paid customers from this channel

2. Direct enterprise outbound through Plug and Play (Tier C)

The Plug and Play Tirana corporate ventures network has active discussions with Carrefour, eBay, Inditex as of June 2026. These conversations don't close in a month — they close in 3–4 months of structured pilot scoping.

Tactics: - 12-week structured pilot framework already defined (Scope → Baseline → Optimize → Measure) - Pilots are positioned as free for the first two enterprise customers in 2026 - Output: case study + co-published agent-readiness benchmark report (optional, partner-approved) - Use Visa Trusted Agent Protocol launch as a wedge — Carrefour is a Visa TAP launch partner

Year 1 enterprise target: 2 enterprise pilots converted to annual contracts (€37.5K ACV avg)

3. Agency partnerships and referral (Tier B amplifier)

The Shopify Plus partner agency ecosystem has ~2,000 agencies globally serving DTC brands. A handful of those agencies own multi-merchant relationships — when an agency adopts écentic as a managed service, they bring 5–20 merchants with them.

Tactics: - Identify 50 Shopify Plus partner agencies with strong AI / measurement positioning - Offer agency tier discounts (20% off Compete for agency-managed accounts) - Co-marketing deals: ghostwritten case studies, joint webinars - Listing in the Shopify Plus partner directory as a recommended tool

Year 1 agency partner target: 10 agencies signed, bringing ~30 merchants

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Channel mix model — Year 1

Channel	Customers	% of customer base	Notes
Shopify App Store organic	70	53%	Highest volume, lowest CAC
Agency partner referral	30	23%	Mid-CAC, higher retention
Outbound direct (GTM Lead)	20	15%	Targeted at Compete tier upgrades

Enterprise (Plug and Play network)

2

1.5%

Highest ACV

Other (press, network, accelerator)

10

7.5%

Low predictability, high prestige

Positioning anchors

Three positioning lines we use consistently across content, sales, and demo:

“We make AI agents buy from your store.” — the headline value prop

“We’re the optimization layer for agent commerce — not generative engine optimization (GEO).” — the differentiation against the obvious adjacent category

“Live on Shopify. Paying merchants. Real lift data.” — the credibility marker

Funnel benchmarks we’re modeling against

Shopify App Store visitor → install conversion: 8–12% (industry standard)

App Store install → first scan completion: 60% (our own data, n=small)

First scan → 14-day trial start: 50%

Trial → paid Connect subscription: 30%

Connect → Compete upgrade (in 60 days): 25%

Compete → Dominate upgrade (in 12 months): 15%

These are targets, not actuals. Actual conversion data will populate in customer-kpis.md and the Key Metrics Dashboard as the App Store launch happens in Q3.

Geographic priority

Year 1 GTM is English-language-first: UK, US, Ireland, Australia, Canada, plus the English-comfortable EU markets (Netherlands, Nordics, Germany). Year 2 adds Spanish (Spain + LatAm) and French (France + Quebec) once we have the content engine to support them.

What we’re explicitly not doing in Year 1

No paid acquisition at scale. Some search ad testing on terms like “Shopify AI optimization” is allowed, capped at €500/mo until we have a documented LTV/CAC payback under 9 months.

No event sponsorship. Conferences are CAC-burning until we have a brand to leverage.

No outbound to enterprises that aren't Plug and Play sourced. Cold enterprise sales is a Series A motion.

No localization of the product. English UI only through Year 1.

No reseller program. That's a Year 2 motion once the agency partner program shows traction.

How we know GTM is working

The leading indicators we watch weekly:

App Store install rate (target: >50/week by M3)

First-scan completion rate (target: >60%)

Connect → paid conversion (target: >30%)

Tier mix moving toward 70/20/10 (Connect / Compete / Dominate)

Pipeline at the Compete and Dominate tier from outbound (target: 8 in pipeline at any time by M3)

Active enterprise pilot conversations (target: 4 in pipeline by M6)

If two or more of these are below target by M4, we change tactics — not the strategy. Pull the GTM Lead hire forward, reallocate marketing spend, or accelerate the content investment.